

What’s the real cost of chasing AGI? Power consolidation is just the start, says the AI Now Institute.

Theresa Loconsolo, Rebecca Bellan — Jul 31, 2025

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [t](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)





Equity
Who really benefits from the AI bo...



SHARE SUBSCRIBE DESCRIPTION



[Listen on Apple Podcasts](#) [Listen on Spotify](#)

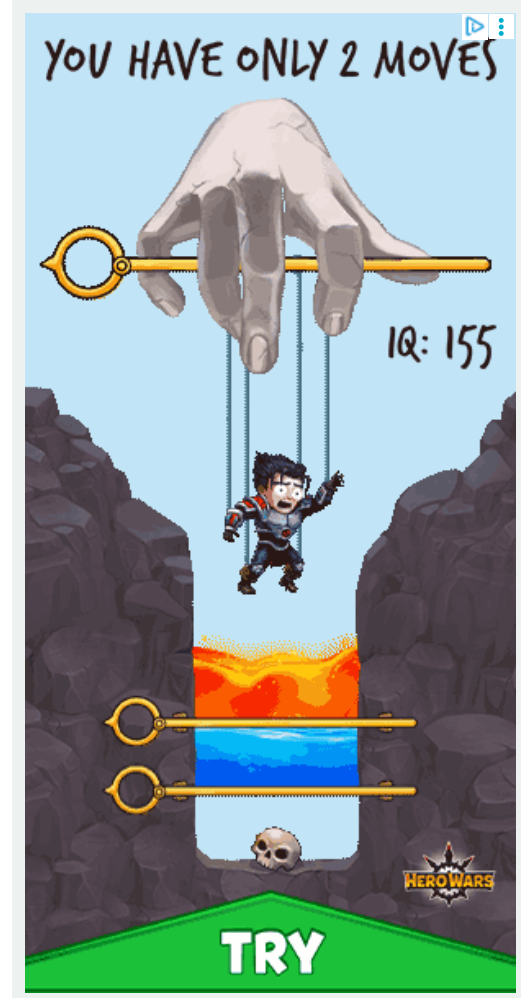
If you've been hearing about [Trump's AI Action Plan](#) and wondering who it actually benefits, you're not alone.

On today's episode of [Equity](#), Rebecca Bellan caught up with Amba Kak and Dr. Sarah Myers West from the AI Now Institute, a think tank focused on the social implications of AI and the consolidation of power in the tech industry. Their [recent report](#), dubbed Artificial Power, lays out the political economy driving today's AI frenzy and what's at stake for everyone else.

Artificial Power pushes back on what AI Now calls the "too big to fail" myth, arguing that AI companies are pouring billions into massive compute infrastructure and foundational models, often with government support, despite shaky business models and limited public accountability.

That push to scale and reach AGI, or artificial general intelligence, before 2030 has real-world consequences that don't disappear with the promises that AI will someday solve humanity's hardest problems. In the short term, societies are already facing environmental degradation, discriminatory algorithms, dismantled democratic institutions, lack of data privacy, and national security risk.

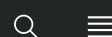
Kak and West say these outcomes are the result of a series of choices, not an unpreventable reality.



Latest
Startups
Venture
Apple

Security
AI
Apps

TE



Events
Podcasts
Newsletters



Theresa Loconsolo

Audio Producer | X

Theresa Loconsolo is an audio producer at TechCrunch focusing on Equity, the network’s flagship podcast. Before joining TechCrunch in 2022, she was one of 2...

View Bio >



Rebecca Bellan

Senior Reporter |  

Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends shaping artificial intelligence. Her work has also...

View Bio >

- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

Latest Equity Episodes

See More



STARTUPS

 Figma’s IPO success is ‘a little bit of a meme stock,’ says Sapphire Ventures’ Jai Das

Rebecca Bellan,
Theresa Loconsolo
- 1 day ago



AI

 From Meta’s massive offers to Anthropic’s massive valuation, does AI have a ceiling?

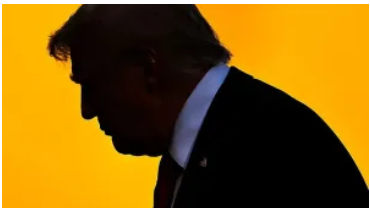
Theresa Loconsolo,
Anthony Ha, Kirsten Korosec,
Maxwell Zeff
- Aug 1, 2025



AI

 What’s the real cost of chasing AGI? Power consolidation is just the start, says the AI Now Institute.

Theresa Loconsolo,
Rebecca Bellan
- Jul 31, 2025



AI

 Should Silicon Valley celebrate Trump’s AI plans?

Anthony Ha,
Theresa Loconsolo,
Kirsten Korosec, Maxwell Zeff
- Jul 25, 2025

YOU HAVE ONLY 2 MOVES

IQ: 155



HERO WARS

TRY



[Contact Us](#)

[RSS Terms of Use](#)

[Cisco](#)

[Advertise](#)

[DeepMind](#)

[Crunchboard](#)

[Windsurf](#)

[Jobs](#)

[Tech Layoffs](#)

[Site Map](#)

[ChatGPT](#)